

Cohen Belongs Among Great Minor Leaguers

AMONG THOSE TO BE HONORED IN METROPOLITAN stadium today will be Andrew Howard Cohen, age 53, manager of the Indianapolis team.

This sends memory scurrying a long way back to a day in Waco, Texas.

The spring training season was on. People were going to the baseball park to see a young shortstop in whom John McGraw, manager of the New York Giants, was said to be interested.

For years McGraw had been looking for a gifted Jewish player because of the popularity he was sure to have in the Polo Grounds.

Andy Cohen, they said, would be the man. That day Cohen came to bat and rifled a home run over the left centerfield fence.

A few days later it was announced that McGraw had closed the deal.

He had Cohen. The New York press expanded on the importance of this move with the same enthusiasm they later lavished on Clint Hartung, Willie Mays and Andre Rodgers.

NOT QUITE THERE

ANDY STAYED WITH THE GIANTS FOR three years and singled his way to a .280 average over that period. However, he was just a bit deficient in power, just a step short of major league fielding range either at shortstop or second base.

He did not miss by much but, in the end, he joined the honored ranks of those known as "great minor leaguers."

There is such a category. It comprises men who have keen baseball minds, fine competitive spirit, all-around skills. They are baseball men in the truest sense; but each lacks one supreme skill which would make him outstanding in the major leagues.

SOME OF THE GREAT ONES

YOU THINK OF SUCH CUNNING, competitive pitchers as Howard Merritt of St. Paul and Tom Sheehan of St. Paul and Minneapolis. You think of such first basemen as Bunney Brief of Kansas City and Joe Hauser of Minneapolis, such outfielders as Bruno Haas of St. Paul, Spencer Harris of Minneapolis, Bevo Lebourveau of Toledo, Buzz Arlett of Oakland and Minneapolis.

And you think of Andy Cohen in his many years of service with Minneapolis.

They were great minor leaguers and they made great contributions to baseball. Cohen was a ball player's ball player. The moves he made were not spectacular but opponents realized he was always hurting them by being where he belonged, doing the right thing.

He is remembered as one of Minneapolis' all-time great ones. He helped the Millers win mainly by never helping them lose. They say baseball games are lost, not won. Well, Andy never lost one. That is the kind of player he was and the record seems to say he has been that kind of manager at El Paso, Dayton and other minor league stops.

Now he is in the American Association and mighty welcome.

His old friends here wish him well and hope he stays around for a long time, or until something better shows up for him.

EYE WITNESS REPORT

THE MINNEAPOLIS TRIBUNE'S MAN, Tom Briere, is back from a swing with the Millers. He has some opinions:

"It's a happy club. The players work well for Red Davis and they hustle.

"Best of the new players by a long way is third baseman Jim Davenport.

"I'm afraid rookie first baseman Orlando Cepeda can be pitched to. He'd just about get by in the field if he hit well; but I doubt if he can. That's only my opinion. Davis and many of the Millers think he will make it. I hope they're right.

"Pitching is the best we've had in a long time; and there is more coming.

"Outfielder Rojas Alou just isn't ready for this league. He's the fastest thing you ever saw and he has a good arm; but he's just not ready.

"Hank Thompson isn't a bad outfielder. When his arm comes around and he can throw he will help.

"Jake Jenkins is starting out just the way he did last year, catching well and hitting well. Perhaps he can hold his spring form longer this year. Right now he's helping a lot.

"Carlos Paula has got to hit a lot to help; but it looks as if he would.

"The Millers are sure to get more pitching help which should make it a great staff. If they can dig up two more lefthanded hitters, they're a ball club."



CULLUM'S COLUMN
by
DICK CULLUM



Cohen